



FOOD FOR THOUGHT

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Your next HYROX starts on your plate

This is not a trend but an athletic event that demands an athlete's respect. Here's a nutritionist's **guide to eating right** before you take the plunge.

HYROX has exploded in India. One event in Bengaluru reportedly pulled in nearly a million dollars in a single day, and suddenly every gym, every corporate group, every weekend warrior wants a bib number.

When someone walks into my clinic these days, there is a one-in-three chance they mention HYROX within the first 10 minutes. The enthusiasm is beautiful. The preparation is often terrifying.

So what is HYROX? It is a global indoor fitness race that combines eight kilometres of running with eight standardised functional workout stations like sled pushes, rowing, and wall balls. It is designed as a test of strength, endurance, and work capacity, open to both elite athletes and everyday fitness enthusiasts.

Let me say this clearly before we go any further. If you haven't trained seriously in over a decade, give yourself nine months before you commit to an event of this intensity. Not nine weeks. Nine months. Your tendons, your cardiovascular system, your recovery capacity — none of these respond to panic-mode bootstrapping. I've seen too many people chase a medal for two or three

months, cross the finish line, then spend the next year nursing a torn meniscus or a stress fracture. HYROX is not a trend you can cram for. It is an athletic event, and it demands an athlete's respect.

Now, assuming you've given yourself a realistic timeline, let's talk about the part most people get catastrophically wrong: nutrition.

Two of my clients, Rishabh Telang and Shwetambari Shetty, took part in HYROX this year, and I could not have been prouder watching them cross that line. Both followed strict, regimented plans customised for their age, body composition, and event category.

Neither of them got there by eating like a regular gym-goer. The difference between finishing and finishing strong — between a respectable time and a podium — is almost always what happens in the kitchen.

HYROX taxes three energy systems simultaneously. You need explosive power for the sled push and burpee broad jumps. You need sustained aerobic capacity for the runs. You need muscular endurance for the wall balls and farmers carry. No single food fixes all three. But a thoughtful nutrition strategy across your training block can.

The foundation rules

Before we get to specific foods, here are the principles I drill into every HYROX client who walks into my clinic.

First, eat for the training session you are about to do, not the one you just finished. Carbohydrate timing around your heavier sessions matters more than total daily carbs. Second, protein should be spread across four to five feeds daily, at roughly 0.3 to 0.4 grams per kilogram of body weight per meal. Third, hydration is not just water. Electrolyte balance, particularly sodium, becomes critical once you start sweating through two-hour training blocks. Fourth, recovery nutrition begins within 45 minutes of finishing a session, not whenever you get home. Fifth, do not experiment on race day. Ever.

Foods that genuinely help

Let me walk you through the 10 foods I keep coming back to with my athletes.

Oats are the unglamorous hero of pre-session fuelling. Slow-release carbohydrates, soluble fibre, and enough B vitamins to support energy metabolism. A bowl of oats with banana and a scoop of whey, eaten 90 minutes before training, is boring but nearly perfect.